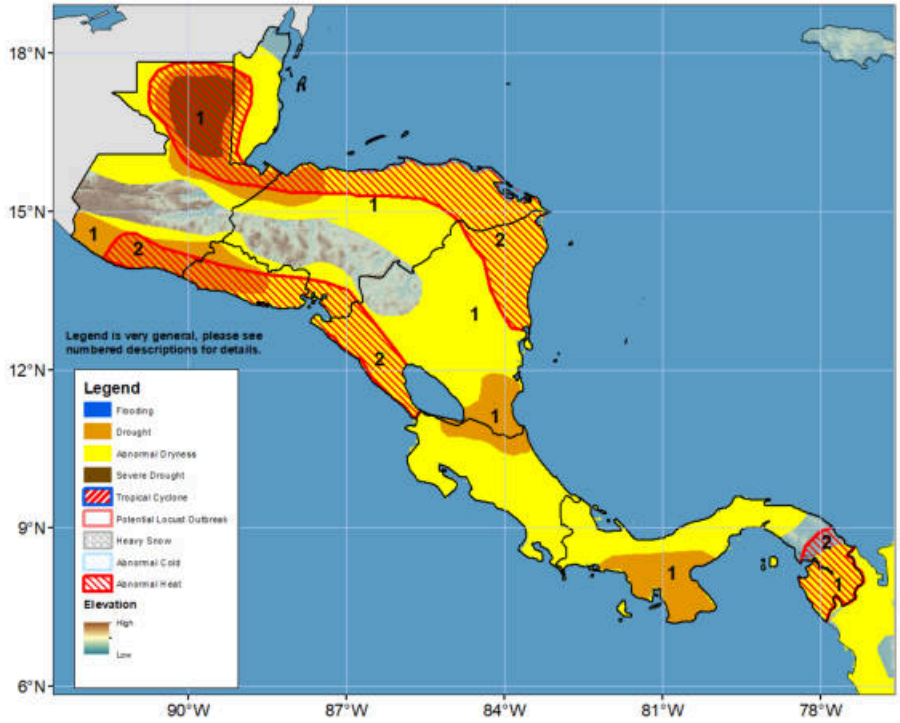
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Climate Prediction Center's Central America Hazards Outlook
For USAID / FEWS-NET
17 – 23 August 2023

Rainfall deficits continue in most parts of Central America, while abnormally warmer temperatures are expected in Guatemala, El Salvador, Honduras, Nicaragua, and Panama.



1) Inconsistent and insufficient rainfall since the beginning of the "Primera" season, starting in April, has led to abnormal dryness across the region, particularly in Guatemala, El Salvador, Honduras, the border between Nicaragua and Costa Rica, and central Panama. Moreover, a severe drought polygon is placed in northern Guatemala due to the continuing and growing rainfall deficits, significant vegetation stress, dry soil conditions, and ground observations. The irregular rains since the start of the Primera season have mainly affected the crops of subsistence farmers in the departments of Zacapa, Chiquimula, Jalapa, Jutiapa, and El Progreso. Due to the lack of continuity of rains, these farmers had to perform at least one or up to three replanting, and they might experience yield reductions of 25% to 50% of average yields. In addition, the high temperatures and the lack of rain have exacerbated moisture availability in the soil.
2) Weekly mean maximum temperatures are forecast to be 30-40°C in some areas of Guatemala, El Salvador, Honduras, Nicaragua, and southern Panama. In these regions, maximum temperatures will likely be warmer than average (0.5-4°C). Therefore, an abnormal heat hazard has been placed in these countries.

Note: The Hazards outlook map is based on current weather/climate information, short and medium-range weather forecasts (up to 1 week), sub-seasonal forecasts up to 4 weeks, and assesses the potential impact of extreme events on crop and pasture conditions. Shaded polygons are added in areas where anomalous conditions have been observed and predicted to continue during the outlook period. The boundaries of these polygons are only approximate at the spatial scale of the map. This product takes into account long-range seasonal climate forecasts but does not reflect current or projected food security conditions. FEWS NET is a USAID-funded activity whose purpose is to provide objective information about food security conditions. Its views are not necessarily reflective of those of USAID or the U.S. Government. The FEWS NET weather hazards outlook process and products include participation by FEWS NET field and home offices, NOAA-CPC, USGS, USDA, NASA, and a number of other national and regional organizations in the countries concerned.

Questions or comments about the hazards outlooks may be directed to Dr. Wassila Thiaw, Head, International Desks/NOAA, wassila.thiaw@noaa.gov. Questions about the USAID FEWS NET activity may be directed to Dr. James Verdin, Program Manager, FEWS NET/USAID, jverdin@usaid.gov